SPREAD LOVE & ACCEPTANCE

# The Workpapers: The Bound Edition

*Every form from the series in one book, on big pages, with room to write*



*by Christian*

Independently published
spreadloveandacceptance.com

*Spread Love & Acceptance*: *The Workpapers*: *The Bound Edition*.
By Christian. Independently published.

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**Free online, always.** Every chapter of the series is free to read at spreadloveandacceptance.com/book, in a short and a full version, with no account and no paid version. The print books are optional. You may copy pages of this workbook for personal use and for non-commercial teaching, with credit to "Spread Love & Acceptance, spreadloveandacceptance.com."

**Not therapy.** This book is general education about people and relationships. It is not a diagnosis, treatment or a replacement for help from a doctor, counselor or other trained professional, and it can't know your situation.

**The examples are made up.** The people in this book's examples are made up; any likeness to real people is coincidence. None of them is a testimonial.

Set in Lora, Fraunces and IBM Plex Mono.

# Contents


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | *How to use this workbook* | 4 |
| | *Your six weeks: a planner* | 5 |
| WP-02 | How much are you carrying? | 6 |
| WP-11 | The Calm-Down Kit | 11 |
| WP-09 | Say it so it lands | 16 |
| WP-13 | The 90-second daily check-in | 20 |
| WP-12 | Same moment, different speeds | 29 |
| WP-14 | Is it us, or is it everything else? | 34 |
| WP-01 | Who did what | 39 |
| WP-03 | One owner per job | 46 |
| | Is the setup working? On paper | 51 |
| WP-04 | What keeps coming back? | 58 |
| WP-15 | Keep your little rituals alive | 65 |
| | *How the numbers work* | 70 |
| | *Notes* | 75 |
| | *The series* | 78 |

# How to use this workbook

*Every workpaper from the books, on big pages with room to write. Pencil is fine. Crossing out is fine. There are no right answers, and nothing here is marked.*

- **One sheet, one go.** Each workpaper opens with a short page that says when to use it, how long it takes, who fills it in and which book explains it. The blank copies follow, one after another.
- **On your own, or together.** Some sheets are only about you, so fill those in for yourself and never for anyone else. On shared sheets, each person writes only their own rows, even when it's very tempting to help.
- **Write what happened.** "Trash missed Tuesday" is useful. "Typical" is not. The sheets look at the setup and the week, and leave everyone's character alone.
- **Need more copies?** Copy a page for your own use, or fill the sheet out free on the website, where it does the sums and keeps what you type on your own device.
- **Go gently.** If a sheet stirs up something heavy, stop. A "not right now" is fine.

### SIX GENTLE WEEKS

If you'd like an order to follow, the six-week program uses the workpapers one small step a week. The next page is a planner for it. Most people miss a week somewhere. That's built in.

# Your six weeks: a planner

*One small step a week. Miss one and you just carry on where you left off. The full program is free at spreadloveandacceptance.com/prog-01.*

| WEEK | THE STEP | WORKPAPERS | START DATE | DONE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Week 0 | Five minutes: read the planner, pick a start day. | None yet | | ☐ |
| Week 1 | See the work that's already happening. | WP-01 Who did what · WP-13 daily check-in | | ☐ |
| Week 2 | Give every job one owner. | WP-03 One owner per job | | ☐ |
| Week 3 | Notice how much each of you is carrying. | WP-02 How much are you carrying? | | ☐ |
| Week 4 | Talk about it kindly. | WP-09 Say it so it lands · WP-11 Calm-Down Kit | | ☐ |
| Week 5 | Look at the pace and the pressure. | WP-12 Same moment, different speeds · WP-14 Is it us? | | ☐ |
| Week 6 | Make it last. | WP-04 What keeps coming back? · WP-15 rituals | | ☐ |

## AT THE END: WHAT CHANGED?

**One thing that is easier now**

**One thing to keep an eye on**

WORKPAPER WP-02

# How much are you carrying?

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | Before any hard talk, and on ordinary days too, so you can see your own pattern. |
| HOW LONG | About 2 minutes |
| WHO | On your own, about yourself only |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 1, Chapter 2 (Your wiring, weather and words); Book 2, Chapter 1 (Stress and the nervous system); Book 3, Chapter 7 (Helping others well); Book 4, Chapter 2 (Is the split working?) |
| COPIES HERE | 4, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*Two minutes, about yourself and nobody else. You may be surprised by your own number. A score of 0.65 on a Tuesday tells you something about Tuesday and nothing whatsoever about your character.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version does the sums for you and keeps what you type on your own device. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-02

# How much are you carrying?



Fill this out on your own, about yourself only. Never fill it out for someone else.

Your name _____ Date _____

## The checklist

Score each row based on how the last 24–48 hours have actually gone. Circle one: 0 = Not at all, 4 = Very true. Living with a long-term illness? Your physical row may always be high. That fills the tank; it isn't a mood.

| | Not at all | | | | Very true |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sleep debt (less rested than usual) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Workload elsewhere (job, school, caregiving) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Recent unresolved conflict (any source) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Physical state (hungry, sick, in pain) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Time pressure today specifically | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

## How full is your stress tank?

Points (add the five circled numbers): _____ out of 20

Tank: points ÷ 20 = _____ out of 1.00

Higher means a fuller tank (and a lower battery). Under 0.30: light. 0.30 to 0.59: medium. 0.60 or more: high. Put off anything that doesn't need deciding in the next hour.

## Optional

☐ Some of what I'm carrying is caring for someone

**Anything you want to name before talking**

A high score is a way to press pause, not a way out. It means "let's come back to this tomorrow," not "this doesn't need to happen."

# How much are you carrying?



Fill this out on your own, about yourself only. Never fill it out for someone else.

Your name _____ Date _____

## The checklist

Score each row based on how the last 24–48 hours have actually gone. Circle one: 0 = Not at all, 4 = Very true. Living with a long-term illness? Your physical row may always be high. That fills the tank; it isn't a mood.

| | Not at all | | | | Very true |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sleep debt (less rested than usual) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
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Your name _____ Date _____

## The checklist

Score each row based on how the last 24–48 hours have actually gone. Circle one: 0 = Not at all, 4 = Very true. Living with a long-term illness? Your physical row may always be high. That fills the tank; it isn't a mood.

| | Not at all | | | | Very true |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sleep debt (less rested than usual) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Workload elsewhere (job, school, caregiving) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Recent unresolved conflict (any source) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Physical state (hungry, sick, in pain) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Time pressure today specifically | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

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# How much are you carrying?



Fill this out on your own, about yourself only. Never fill it out for someone else.

Your name _____ Date _____

## The checklist

Score each row based on how the last 24–48 hours have actually gone. Circle one: 0 = Not at all, 4 = Very true. Living with a long-term illness? Your physical row may always be high. That fills the tank; it isn't a mood.

| | Not at all | | | | Very true |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sleep debt (less rested than usual) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Workload elsewhere (job, school, caregiving) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Recent unresolved conflict (any source) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Physical state (hungry, sick, in pain) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| Time pressure today specifically | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

## How full is your stress tank?

Points (add the five circled numbers): _____ out of 20

Tank: points ÷ 20 = _____ out of 1.00

Higher means a fuller tank (and a lower battery). Under 0.30: light. 0.30 to 0.59: medium. 0.60 or more: high. Put off anything that doesn't need deciding in the next hour.

## Optional

☐ Some of what I'm carrying is caring for someone

**Anything you want to name before talking**

A high score is a way to press pause, not a way out. It means "let's come back to this tomorrow," not "this doesn't need to happen."

WORKPAPER WP-11

# The Calm-Down Kit

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | On a calm day, before you need it. Look at it again after a heated moment. |
| HOW LONG | About 10 minutes |
| WHO | On your own; the pause plan is made to share |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 1, Chapter 2 (Your wiring, weather and words); Book 1, Chapter 3 (Who you are becoming); Book 1, Chapter 4 (How feelings work); Book 2, Chapter 1 (Stress and the nervous system) |
| COPIES HERE | 2, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*Make this on a dull, ordinary day, ideally with a cup of tea. Trying to write a calm-down plan in the middle of a fight is like reading the instructions on a fire extinguisher while the pan is still burning.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version keeps a copy on your own device, and nothing is sent anywhere. `spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-11`

# The Calm-Down Kit

WP-11 · copy 1 of 2

A short plan, made ahead of time, for calming your body down enough to have the conversation, or to put it off honestly. Fill in Part A on an ordinary day, not a hard one. Your kit is yours; only the pause plan is made to share.

Whose kit is this? (your name) _____ Date _____

## Part A: What tends to start it

| What tends to start it | How it shows up in my body first |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |

## Part A: My two defaults

Pick two calming steps now: asymmetric breathing (breathe in for 4, out for 6) · naming the room (5 things you see, 4 you hear, 3 you can touch) · weight and pressure (feet pressed firmly into the floor, or something warm held in both hands) · gating (cutting noise and light: lower the lights, step out) · walking it out · a low, steady sound.

First default _____ Second, if the first isn't available _____

## Part A: My pause line

Say how you are, how long you need, and when you'll be back: "I'm at capacity. I need ten minutes. I'll be back at a quarter after."

## Our pause plan (agree it together, and share it)

Our pause word or signal _____ The shortest break we take _____

How we set the time to come back

The first sentence when we come back

**Part B, in the moment:** say your pause word or line, then do your first calming step.

## Part C: Coming back

Still hot? Another round. Twice? Name a new time. Settled enough to listen? Go back at the time you named. (For number fans: your stress tank score, 0 to 1. Under 0.50, go back. From 0.50 to 0.59, take another round. At 0.60 or above after two rounds, put it off.)

| Time | What I did | How I feel now (Still hot / Settled enough) | Stress tank before (0–1) | Stress tank after (0–1) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

Next small action

If you put the conversation off: when you'll pick it back up

## Where I've landed

☐ I'm going with this

Look at this again on (optional)

Nothing in this kit works by cold, pain or shock, and none of it is treatment.

# The Calm-Down Kit



A short plan, made ahead of time, for calming your body down enough to have the conversation, or to put it off honestly. Fill in Part A on an ordinary day, not a hard one. Your kit is yours; only the pause plan is made to share.

Whose kit is this? (your name)

Date

## Part A: What tends to start it

| What tends to start it | How it shows up in my body first |
|---|---|
| | |
| | |
| | |

## Part A: My two defaults

Pick two calming steps now: asymmetric breathing (breathe in for 4, out for 6) · naming the room (5 things you see, 4 you hear, 3 you can touch) · weight and pressure (feet pressed firmly into the floor, or something warm held in both hands) · gating (cutting noise and light: lower the lights, step out) · walking it out · a low, steady sound.

First default

Second, if the first isn't available

## Part A: My pause line

Say how you are, how long you need, and when you'll be back: "I'm at capacity. I need ten minutes. I'll be back at a quarter after."

## Our pause plan (agree it together, and share it)

Our pause word or signal

The shortest break we take

How we set the time to come back

The first sentence when we come back

**Part B, in the moment:** say your pause word or line, then do your first calming step.

## Part C: Coming back

Still hot? Another round. Twice? Name a new time. Settled enough to listen? Go back at the time you named. (For number fans: your stress tank score, 0 to 1. Under 0.50, go back. From 0.50 to 0.59, take another round. At 0.60 or above after two rounds, put it off.)

| Time | What I did | How I feel now (Still hot / Settled enough) | Stress tank before (0–1) | Stress tank after (0–1) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | |
| | | | | |
| | | | | |

Next small action

If you put the conversation off: when you'll pick it back up

## Where I've landed

☐ I'm going with this

Look at this again on (optional)

Nothing in this kit works by cold, pain or shock, and none of it is treatment.

WORKPAPER WP-09

# Say it so it lands

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | Before you answer something that stung. |
| HOW LONG | About 5 minutes |
| WHO | On your own, about your own side |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 3, Chapter 1 (Why we get out of tune); Book 3, Chapter 2 (How communication works); Book 3, Chapter 6 (Groups, influence and culture); Book 4, Chapter 4 (Two kinds of fair) |
| COPIES HERE | 3, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*For one thing that actually stung, not a list of grievances. It's a check on your side of the conversation. Most people find the first draft of their reply is about twice as long as it needs to be.*



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# Say it so it lands



A self-check each of you uses on your own side of a conversation. Use it on one thing that actually stung.

Your name _____ Date _____

## Before you speak or send: fact, feeling, ask

**Raw reaction (optional, and just for you)**

**What's the fact underneath this? (One sentence, no adjectives.) For example: "The trash went out late on Tuesday."**

**What's the feeling underneath this? (Frustrated, tired, unseen, rushed…) A feeling about you, not a verdict about them.**

**What's the actual ask? (What do you want to happen next, specifically?) Something the other person can say yes to.**

## Before you react: four quick checks

| Check | Circle one |
|---|---|
| Is this about a specific, nameable task or event? | Yes · No |
| Would I read this the same way if I weren't already carrying a lot? | Yes · No · Not sure |
| Is there a neutral interpretation that also fits what was said? | Yes · No |
| Am I responding to their words, or to a pattern from a past conversation? | Their words · A past pattern |

A "No" or "Not sure" on the second check, a "Yes" on the third or "A past pattern" on the fourth are good reasons to pause first. A kind "not right now" and a time to come back keep it honest.

# Say it so it lands



A self-check each of you uses on your own side of a conversation. Use it on one thing that actually stung.

Your name _____ Date _____

## Before you speak or send: fact, feeling, ask

**Raw reaction (optional, and just for you)**

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# Say it so it lands



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|---|---|
| Is this about a specific, nameable task or event? | Yes · No |
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| Am I responding to their words, or to a pattern from a past conversation? | Their words · A past pattern |

A "No" or "Not sure" on the second check, a "Yes" on the third or "A past pattern" on the fourth are good reasons to pause first. A kind "not right now" and a time to come back keep it honest.

WORKPAPER WP-13

# The 90-second daily check-in

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | Once a day, for a week at a time: one sheet a week. |
| HOW LONG | About 90 seconds a day |
| WHO | Together; each person fills in only their own rows. Three or more of you: use two sheets |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 2, Chapter 6 (Habits and change); Book 3, Chapter 1 (Why we get out of tune) |
| COPIES HERE | 4, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*Ninety seconds, once a day, both of you. It's meant to be almost too small to bother with, which is exactly why it keeps going. If you miss a day, write nothing and carry on tomorrow.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version keeps a copy on your own device, and nothing is sent anywhere. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-13

# The 90-second daily check-in



Each person answers each prompt in one sentence, about their own day, and fills in only their own rows. No debating, no solving, no arguing back. Anything that needs a real discussion waits for the weekly catch-up.

Week beginning

## Each day

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## The weekly catch-up (optional)

Skim the week for anything that came up more than twice, and move it to the right worksheet.

| Sore spot that keeps coming up | Times this week | Move to (One owner per job / Say it so it lands / Keep watching) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

# The 90-second daily check-in



Each person answers each prompt in one sentence, about their own day, and fills in only their own rows. No debating, no solving, no arguing back. Anything that needs a real discussion waits for the weekly catch-up.

Week beginning

## Each day

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## The weekly catch-up (optional)

Skim the week for anything that came up more than twice, and move it to the right worksheet.

| Sore spot that keeps coming up | Times this week | Move to (One owner per job / Say it so it lands / Keep watching) |
|---|---|---|
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Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

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Each person answers each prompt in one sentence, about their own day, and fills in only their own rows. No debating, no solving, no arguing back. Anything that needs a real discussion waits for the weekly catch-up.

Week beginning

## Each day

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## The weekly catch-up (optional)

Skim the week for anything that came up more than twice, and move it to the right worksheet.

| Sore spot that keeps coming up | Times this week | Move to (One owner per job / Say it so it lands / Keep watching) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

# The 90-second daily check-in



Each person answers each prompt in one sentence, about their own day, and fills in only their own rows. No debating, no solving, no arguing back. Anything that needs a real discussion waits for the weekly catch-up.

Week beginning

## Each day

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Stress tank (Light / Medium / High) | One thing I appreciated today | One small thing that didn't feel great | One thing that would help tomorrow |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## The weekly catch-up (optional)

Skim the week for anything that came up more than twice, and move it to the right worksheet.

| Sore spot that keeps coming up | Times this week | Move to (One owner per job / Say it so it lands / Keep watching) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

WORKPAPER WP-12

# Same moment, different speeds

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | Once, then again every few months or after a big change. |
| HOW LONG | About 20 minutes |
| WHO | Together; each person fills in their own rows first |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 3, Chapter 1 (Why we get out of tune), and in full, free online at spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/wp-12-same-moment-different-speeds |
| COPIES HERE | 2, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*Fill in your own rows first, before you look at theirs. Often one moment stands out a mile, bedtime, say, or the first ten minutes after someone gets home.*

**How to read your answers.** Look at Part B first. A gap of two or more steps on the same moment is where most friction starts, so that's the moment for Part C. A gap in speed is about pace. It says nothing about how much either of you cares. If your answers barely differ, the friction is probably coming from somewhere else, tiredness or pressure from outside.

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version keeps a copy on your own device, and nothing is sent anywhere. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-12

# Same moment, different speeds

WP-12 · copy 1 of 2

For a few moments that come over often, each person marks how fast they want to move, how much they want to talk, and how urgent it feels. Each person fills in only their own rows, ideally before looking at the other's. There are no right answers.

Date

## Part A: Each person's speed

Speed: right away · within the hour · later the same day · after a night's sleep. Talk: quiet time first · a few words, then act · talk it all through. Urgency: low · medium · high.

| Moment | Person | Speed | Talk | Urgency | What helps me (optional) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A plan changes at the last minute | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| A bill, letter or form needs dealing with | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Something breaks or goes wrong at home | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| One of us is upset about something | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Deciding what to do with free time | | | | | |
| | | | | | |

## Part B: Where your speeds differ

For each moment, count how many steps apart your answers are on each list. Start with the biggest gap: a difference in pace, not in how much anyone cares.

| Moment | Speed gap | Talk gap | Urgency gap |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part C: One small agreement

| Moment | What we'll try | Try it until |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

Agreeing means you have both seen the gaps and will try the agreement. It doesn't mean either of you has to change speed for good.

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

Not a compatibility test and not a diagnosis. Run it again every few months, or after a big change.

# Same moment, different speeds



For a few moments that come over often, each person marks how fast they want to move, how much they want to talk, and how urgent it feels. Each person fills in only their own rows, ideally before looking at the other's. There are no right answers.

Date

## Part A: Each person's speed

Speed: right away · within the hour · later the same day · after a night's sleep. Talk: quiet time first · a few words, then act · talk it all through. Urgency: low · medium · high.

| Moment | Person | Speed | Talk | Urgency | What helps me (optional) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A plan changes at the last minute | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| A bill, letter or form needs dealing with | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Something breaks or goes wrong at home | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| One of us is upset about something | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Deciding what to do with free time | | | | | |
| | | | | | |

## Part B: Where your speeds differ

For each moment, count how many steps apart your answers are on each list. Start with the biggest gap: a difference in pace, not in how much anyone cares.

| Moment | Speed gap | Talk gap | Urgency gap |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part C: One small agreement

| Moment | What we'll try | Try it until |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

Agreeing means you have both seen the gaps and will try the agreement. It doesn't mean either of you has to change speed for good.

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

Not a compatibility test and not a diagnosis. Run it again every few months, or after a big change.

WORKPAPER WP-14

# Is it us, or is it everything else?

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | For one week in a hard stretch, a line each evening. |
| HOW LONG | A minute a day, then 15 minutes |
| WHO | Together |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 4, Chapter 3 (Full tanks and different angles), and in full, free online at spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/wp-14-is-it-us-or-everything-else |
| COPIES HERE | 2, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*A line each evening, about your own day. At the end of the week, the question is simple. Was it us, or was it everything else? Quite often it was everything else.*

**How to read your answers.** In Part B, count the tense moments that fell on heavy days. If most did, outside pressure is doing a lot of the damage, and a plan for the pressure (Part D) will help more than talking about each other. If most came on light days, the friction really does start between you, and Say it so it lands or the monthly look-back is the next thing to try.

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version keeps a copy on your own device, and nothing is sent anywhere. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-14

# Is it us, or is it everything else?

WP-14 · copy 1 of 2

A one-week log that keeps two things apart: pressure from outside (money, work, health, sleep, family) and friction that really starts between you. A line or two each evening, each person about their own day. Write what happened, not who was wrong.

Week beginning

## Part A: Each evening

| Day | Person | Outside pressure today (None / A little / A lot) | Where it came from | A tense moment between us (if any) | Looking back, it was mostly (Outside pressure / Between us / Some of both / Not sure yet) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Tue | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Wed | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Thu | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Fri | | | | | |
| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Outside pressure today (None / A little / A lot) | Where it came from | A tense moment between us (if any) | Looking back, it was mostly (Outside pressure / Between us / Some of both / Not sure yet) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## Part B: The week at a glance

Tense moments on heavy days: _____ of _____

## Part C: What got blamed on the wrong thing?

| The moment | What it seemed to be about | What was really going on | What would help next time |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part D: One plan for the pressure

The pressure we're facing right now

How we'll flag a heavy day

What we'll go easy on until it passes

One bit of outside help we could ask for (optional)

Outside pressure explains a hard day. It doesn't excuse unkindness, and it doesn't make what anyone felt less real.

# Is it us, or is it everything else?

WP-14 · copy 2 of 2

A one-week log that keeps two things apart: pressure from outside (money, work, health, sleep, family) and friction that really starts between you. A line or two each evening, each person about their own day. Write what happened, not who was wrong.

Week beginning

## Part A: Each evening

| Day | Person | Outside pressure today (None / A little / A lot) | Where it came from | A tense moment between us (if any) | Looking back, it was mostly (Outside pressure / Between us / Some of both / Not sure yet) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | | |
| Mon | | | | | |
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| Sat | | | | | |

| Day | Person | Outside pressure today (None / A little / A lot) | Where it came from | A tense moment between us (if any) | Looking back, it was mostly (Outside pressure / Between us / Some of both / Not sure yet) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sat | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |
| Sun | | | | | |

## Part B: The week at a glance

Tense moments on heavy days: _____ of _____

## Part C: What got blamed on the wrong thing?

| The moment | What it seemed to be about | What was really going on | What would help next time |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part D: One plan for the pressure

The pressure we're facing right now

How we'll flag a heavy day

What we'll go easy on until it passes

One bit of outside help we could ask for (optional)

Outside pressure explains a hard day. It doesn't excuse unkindness, and it doesn't make what anyone felt less real.

WORKPAPER WP-01

# Who did what

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | For one ordinary week: one sheet a week. |
| HOW LONG | A few minutes a day |
| WHO | Together; write only what you did or saw yourself |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 4, Chapter 1 (The work nobody sees); Book 4, Chapter 2 (Is the split working?); Book 4, Chapter 5 (The monthly look-back) |
| COPIES HERE | 3, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*One ordinary week. Write only what you did or saw yourself, including the thinking jobs, the remembering and the booking. Nobody fills in anybody else's side, however sure they are.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version does the sums for you and keeps what you type on your own device. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-01

# Who did what

WP-01 · copy 1 of 3

Write down what actually happened this week, before anyone starts remembering it as a story. Write down only what you did or saw yourself; never fill in someone else's side for them.

Person A _____ Person B _____

Week beginning _____

## Part A: Who did what, this week

One row for each task noticed or done, including the invisible ones: remembering, planning, booking, forms. Time spent only thinking, noticing or planning counts too: log it as "Thinking and planning."

| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
|---|---|---|---|---|
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| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
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## This week's totals

Person A: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Person B: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Workload balance score: 1 − (A% − B%, ignoring any minus sign) ÷ 100 =

## Part B (optional): Kind ways to say no

For a request you can't take on this week: say why the request is fair, say honestly what you have left, and offer something instead.

Describes how the logged work was split this week, not anyone in it. How the score works: "How the numbers work," page **70** of this workbook.

# Who did what

WP-01 · copy 2 of 3

Write down what actually happened this week, before anyone starts remembering it as a story. Write down only what you did or saw yourself; never fill in someone else's side for them.

Person A _____ Person B _____

Week beginning _____

## Part A: Who did what, this week

One row for each task noticed or done, including the invisible ones: remembering, planning, booking, forms. Time spent only thinking, noticing or planning counts too: log it as "Thinking and planning."

| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
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| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
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## This week's totals

Person A: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Person B: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Workload balance score: 1 − (A% − B%, ignoring any minus sign) ÷ 100 =

## Part B (optional): Kind ways to say no

For a request you can't take on this week: say why the request is fair, say honestly what you have left, and offer something instead.

Describes how the logged work was split this week, not anyone in it. How the score works: "How the numbers work," page **70** of this workbook.

# Who did what

WP-01 · copy 3 of 3

Write down what actually happened this week, before anyone starts remembering it as a story. Write down only what you did or saw yourself; never fill in someone else's side for them.

Person A

Person B

Week beginning

## Part A: Who did what, this week

One row for each task noticed or done, including the invisible ones: remembering, planning, booking, forms. Time spent only thinking, noticing or planning counts too: log it as "Thinking and planning."

| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
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| Day | Task noticed or done | Who did it | Minutes (rough) | How it came up: asked for, noticed, or thinking time? |
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## This week's totals

Person A: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Person B: minutes (and %), of which noticed and handled without being asked

Workload balance score: 1 − (A% − B%, ignoring any minus sign) ÷ 100 =

## Part B (optional): Kind ways to say no

For a request you can't take on this week: say why the request is fair, say honestly what you have left, and offer something instead.

Describes how the logged work was split this week, not anyone in it. How the score works: "How the numbers work," page **70** of this workbook.

WORKPAPER WP-03

# One owner per job

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | When jobs only get done after someone asks. Redo it when life changes. |
| HOW LONG | About 10 minutes |
| WHO | Together |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 2, Chapter 6 (Habits and change); Book 3, Chapter 6 (Groups, influence and culture); Book 3, Chapter 7 (Helping others well); Book 4, Chapter 2 (Is the split working?) |
| COPIES HERE | 2, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*A name next to every regular job, and a second name if you like for someone who notices when it slips. Leave the jobs nobody owns on the list, because they are the reason you're doing this. A made-up example of how it tends to go: when Sian and Huw did theirs at the kitchen table, nineteen jobs went on the list and fourteen had a name within five minutes. The other five, which included the car registration and Huw's mom's birthday, took the rest of the evening, and the car registration turned out to be two weeks overdue.*



**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version does the sums for you and keeps what you type on your own device. `spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-03`

# One owner per job



Every regular job gets one owner, the person who does it and sees it through. If you like, add a helper or backup who pitches in, notices if it slips, or covers it on a bad week. List the invisible jobs too: forms, gifts, renewals, planning, appointments.

Date of this list

The split you agreed (optional)

## Who owns each job

| Job | How often | Owner | Helper or backup (optional) | Size (optional) | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
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How often: Daily, Weekly, Monthly, As needed, Ongoing. Size: Small, Medium, Big.

## Does every job have an owner?

Jobs with an owner: _____ of _____ = _____ out of 1.00

## Changes to the list (optional)

| Date | What changed | Who |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

Agreeing means everyone has read this version and knows who owns what. It doesn't mean every job feels perfectly fair, only that ownership is clear.

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

# One owner per job



Every regular job gets one owner, the person who does it and sees it through. If you like, add a helper or backup who pitches in, notices if it slips, or covers it on a bad week. List the invisible jobs too: forms, gifts, renewals, planning, appointments.

Date of this list

The split you agreed (optional)

## Who owns each job

| Job | How often | Owner | Helper or backup (optional) | Size (optional) | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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How often: Daily, Weekly, Monthly, As needed, Ongoing. Size: Small, Medium, Big.

## Does every job have an owner?

Jobs with an owner: _____ of _____ = _____ out of 1.00

## Changes to the list (optional)

| Date | What changed | Who |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Where we've landed

Agreeing means everyone has read this version and knows who owns what. It doesn't mean every job feels perfectly fair, only that ownership is clear.

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

A PAPER VERSION OF THE SETUP SCORE

# Is the setup working? On paper

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | About once a month, with a week of Who did what, your job list and each person's stress tank. |
| HOW LONG | About 15 minutes |
| WHO | Together; each person scores only their own tank |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 4, Chapter 2 (Is the split working?) |
| COPIES HERE | 3, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*The sums from Book 4, done with a pencil. You'll need a week of Who did what, your job list, and each person's own tank score. If anyone's tank is 0.60 or more, start there, whatever the total says.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version does the sums for you and keeps what you type on your own device. spreadloveandacceptance.com/is-the-setup-working

# Is the setup working? On paper



The setup score from Book 4, Chapter 2, worked out with a pencil. You need one week of Who did what, your job list from One owner per job, and each person's How much are you carrying? score from the same day. Each person scores only their own tank.

Date _____ Who is filling this in _____

## Part A: Balance (how the hours split)

Hours, person A _____ Hours, person B _____

Total _____

A's share: hours ÷ total × 100 = _____ % B's share = _____ %

Balance = 1 − (the gap between the two shares) ÷ 100 = _____

Three or more of you, or an uneven split you agreed on purpose: see "How the numbers work."

## Part B: Ownership (does each job have a name?)

Jobs with an owner _____ All jobs on the list _____

Ownership = owned ÷ all = _____

## Part C: Stress tanks

Person A's tank _____ Person B's tank _____

Average _____

If anyone's tank is 0.60 or more, talk about that first, whatever the score says.

## Part D: The setup score

Balance × 0.40 = _____

Ownership × 0.35 = _____

(1 − average tank) × 0.25 = _____

Add the three: setup score = _____

0.70 or more: working well. 0.40 up to 0.70: needs a look. Below 0.40: needs a rethink, together.

## Part E: The biggest shortfall

Balance: 0.40 − _____ = _____

Ownership: 0.35 − _____ = _____

Tank: 0.25 − _____ = _____

The biggest one is _____

One small change we'll try _____

Look again on _____

It describes the setup, never a person. A worked example: "How the numbers work," at the back of this workbook.

# Is the setup working? On paper



The setup score from Book 4, Chapter 2, worked out with a pencil. You need one week of Who did what, your job list from One owner per job, and each person's How much are you carrying? score from the same day. Each person scores only their own tank.

Date _____ Who is filling this in _____

## Part A: Balance (how the hours split)

Hours, person A _____ Hours, person B _____

Total _____

A's share: hours ÷ total × 100 = _____ % B's share = _____ %

Balance = 1 − (the gap between the two shares) ÷ 100 = _____

Three or more of you, or an uneven split you agreed on purpose: see "How the numbers work."

## Part B: Ownership (does each job have a name?)

Jobs with an owner _____ All jobs on the list _____

Ownership = owned ÷ all = _____

## Part C: Stress tanks

Person A's tank _____ Person B's tank _____

Average _____

If anyone's tank is 0.60 or more, talk about that first, whatever the score says.

## Part D: The setup score

Balance × 0.40 = _____

Ownership × 0.35 = _____

(1 − average tank) × 0.25 = _____

Add the three: setup score = _____

0.70 or more: working well. 0.40 up to 0.70: needs a look. Below 0.40: needs a rethink, together.

## Part E: The biggest shortfall

Balance: 0.40 − _____ = _____

Ownership: 0.35 − _____ = _____

Tank: 0.25 − _____ = _____

The biggest one is _____

One small change we'll try _____

Look again on _____

It describes the setup, never a person. A worked example: "How the numbers work," at the back of this workbook.

# Is the setup working? On paper



The setup score from Book 4, Chapter 2, worked out with a pencil. You need one week of Who did what, your job list from One owner per job, and each person's How much are you carrying? score from the same day. Each person scores only their own tank.

Date _____ Who is filling this in _____

## Part A: Balance (how the hours split)

Hours, person A _____ Hours, person B _____

Total _____

A's share: hours ÷ total × 100 = _____ % B's share = _____ %

Balance = 1 − (the gap between the two shares) ÷ 100 = _____

Three or more of you, or an uneven split you agreed on purpose: see "How the numbers work."

## Part B: Ownership (does each job have a name?)

Jobs with an owner _____ All jobs on the list _____

Ownership = owned ÷ all = _____

## Part C: Stress tanks

Person A's tank _____ Person B's tank _____

Average _____

If anyone's tank is 0.60 or more, talk about that first, whatever the score says.

## Part D: The setup score

Balance × 0.40 = _____

Ownership × 0.35 = _____

(1 − average tank) × 0.25 = _____

Add the three: setup score = _____

0.70 or more: working well. 0.40 up to 0.70: needs a look. Below 0.40: needs a rethink, together.

## Part E: The biggest shortfall

Balance: 0.40 − _____ = _____

Ownership: 0.35 − _____ = _____

Tank: 0.25 − _____ = _____

The biggest one is _____

One small change we'll try _____

Look again on _____

It describes the setup, never a person. A worked example: "How the numbers work," at the back of this workbook.

WORKPAPER WP-04

# What keeps coming back?

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | Once a month, looking back over four weeks. |
| HOW LONG | About 20 minutes |
| WHO | Together |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 1, Chapter 3 (Who you are becoming); Book 4, Chapter 5 (The monthly look-back) |
| COPIES HERE | 3, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*Once a month, twenty minutes, something nice to drink. Start with one thing that went well. You're looking for the jobs that keep slipping, and nobody is in the dock. Another made-up example: Ifan and Kemal's first look-back found the trash slipped three weeks out of four, every time on the week Kemal was on late shifts, so Ifan took the trash and Kemal took the Sunday shop. It took eleven minutes, most of it spent finding a pen.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version does the sums for you and keeps what you type on your own device. `spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-04`

# What keeps coming back?

WP-04 · copy 1 of 3

A monthly look-back, done together, across four weeks of Who did what and One owner per job. It looks for the tasks that keep slipping. You're looking for where the setup needs a fix. Nobody is adding up what anyone owes.

Month

## Part A: Gather the month's notes

List every task that was noticed but not done, or done only after being raised more than once. Mark an ✗ for each week it came up.

| Task | Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3 | Week 4 | Times flagged |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
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## Part B: Sort each gap

Sort every task flagged twice or more. A **structural gap** has no clear owner (fix One owner per job now). A **capacity issue** has an owner who can't keep up (set a time for an honest conversation). A **one-off** has a temporary cause (note it and move on).

| Task | Named owner on the job list? (Yes / No) | Classification | Action |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part C: Wrap up the audit

Structural gaps found

Capacity issues found

One-offs

## Part D (optional): Thanked, or only noticed when it's missed?

| Job | Gets thanked (Often / Sometimes / Rarely / Never) | Only noticed when missed? (Yes / No) | One way to notice it |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

Not a bill for the past, and not a performance review. A task with no owner is a gap in the setup, not a verdict on the person who kept covering it.

# What keeps coming back?



A monthly look-back, done together, across four weeks of Who did what and One owner per job. It looks for the tasks that keep slipping. You're looking for where the setup needs a fix. Nobody is adding up what anyone owes.

Month

## Part A: Gather the month's notes

List every task that was noticed but not done, or done only after being raised more than once. Mark an ✗ for each week it came up.

| Task | Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3 | Week 4 | Times flagged |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
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## Part B: Sort each gap

Sort every task flagged twice or more. A **structural gap** has no clear owner (fix One owner per job now). A **capacity issue** has an owner who can't keep up (set a time for an honest conversation). A **one-off** has a temporary cause (note it and move on).

| Task | Named owner on the job list? (Yes / No) | Classification | Action |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
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## Part C: Wrap up the audit

Structural gaps found

Capacity issues found

One-offs

## Part D (optional): Thanked, or only noticed when it's missed?

| Job | Gets thanked (Often / Sometimes / Rarely / Never) | Only noticed when missed? (Yes / No) | One way to notice it |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

Not a bill for the past, and not a performance review. A task with no owner is a gap in the setup, not a verdict on the person who kept covering it.

# What keeps coming back?



A monthly look-back, done together, across four weeks of Who did what and One owner per job. It looks for the tasks that keep slipping. You're looking for where the setup needs a fix. Nobody is adding up what anyone owes.

Month

## Part A: Gather the month's notes

List every task that was noticed but not done, or done only after being raised more than once. Mark an ✗ for each week it came up.

| Task | Week 1 | Week 2 | Week 3 | Week 4 | Times flagged |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| | | | | | |
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| | | | | | |

## Part B: Sort each gap

Sort every task flagged twice or more. A **structural gap** has no clear owner (fix One owner per job now). A **capacity issue** has an owner who can't keep up (set a time for an honest conversation). A **one-off** has a temporary cause (note it and move on).

| Task | Named owner on the job list? (Yes / No) | Classification | Action |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part C: Wrap up the audit

Structural gaps found

Capacity issues found

One-offs

## Part D (optional): Thanked, or only noticed when it's missed?

| Job | Gets thanked (Often / Sometimes / Rarely / Never) | Only noticed when missed? (Yes / No) | One way to notice it |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

Not a bill for the past, and not a performance review. A task with no owner is a gap in the setup, not a verdict on the person who kept covering it.

WORKPAPER WP-15

# Keep your little rituals alive

| | |
|---|---|
| WHEN | About every three months. |
| HOW LONG | About 15 minutes |
| WHO | Together |
| EXPLAINED IN | Book 2, Chapter 7 (Values, meaning and a good life); Book 3, Chapter 4 (Attachment, trust and belonging); Book 3, Chapter 5 (Closeness and love) |
| COPIES HERE | 2, one after the other. Photocopy them for your own use, or print more free from the website, where you can also fill the form out on screen. |

*The Sunday walk, the birthday breakfast, the silly thing you always say at the door. Every few months, see which are still alive. Nobody is to blame for one that faded.*

**Fill it out on screen, free.** The online version keeps a copy on your own device, and nothing is sent anywhere. spreadloveandacceptance.com/workpapers/fill/wp-15

# Keep your little rituals alive

WP-15 · copy 1 of 2

Every three months or so, a short look at the small shared habits that keep you close: the morning coffee, the Sunday walk, the birthday breakfast. Nobody is to blame for one that lapsed.

Date

## Part A: Our rituals, big and small

How it's doing: Alive (still happening, still means something) · Fading (on autopilot or less often) · Stopped · New idea. How often: Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly, Now and then.

| Ritual or habit | How often | How it's doing | What it gives us, or what got in the way |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |
| | | | |

## Part B: Count them

Alive _____ Fading _____

Stopped _____

New idea _____

## Part C: One to restart, or start

The ritual

The smallest version that still counts

The first time: when, and who will suggest it

What would make it easy to skip, and how we'll protect it (optional)

## Part D (optional): One to let go, with thanks

The ritual

What it gave us

## Where we've landed

☐ We're agreed on this

Who agreed (optional)

Look at this again on (optional)

A ritual is something you would both miss, not a test of love. Look at this sheet again in about three months.

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# How the numbers work

*Every number in this book is arithmetic you can do with a pencil. None of them is a test, a diagnosis or a verdict on anyone: they describe a week, a load or a way of sharing work. The weights and cut-offs are this book's own rules of thumb, not research findings, and you are free to disagree with them. The worked examples are the book's own, so you can check them against the chapters.*

Two habits run through all of them. **Scores are rounded to two decimal places before their band is read,** so the number you see and the words you see always agree. And **nobody's score is ever worked out for them:** if someone's own answer is missing, the total waits.

## The stress tank: How much are you carrying?

You score five things from 0 (not at all) to 4 (very true), about the last day or two: sleep debt, workload elsewhere, unresolved conflict, your physical state, and time pressure today.

```
tank = (sleep + workload + conflict + body + time) ÷ 20
```

The answer runs from 0 to 1, and **higher means fuller**. Under 0.30 is light, 0.30 up to 0.60 medium, and 0.60 or more high. (The worksheet splits each band in two for its words: very light under 0.15, light, medium on the lighter side under 0.45, medium on the heavier side, high under 0.80, and very high from 0.80.) Your **battery** is the other side of the same thing, the energy you have left, so a full tank means a low battery. The battery is a picture in words, not a second score.

WORKED EXAMPLE Rosa, from Book 4, Chapter 3, page 51, scores sleep 3, workload 4, conflict 1, body 2 and time 3.

`3 + 4 + 1 + 2 + 3 = 13; 13 ÷ 20 = 0.65`, which is in the high band.

**Two or more of you:** each person scores only themselves, and the shared figure is the plain average of everyone's own scores. If any one person is at 0.60 or more, treat that as the headline, whatever the average says.

**Coming back after a pause** (the Calm-Down Kit): if you like numbers, take the score again after a calming round. Under 0.50, go back at the time you named. From 0.50 to 0.59, take another round. At 0.60 or more after two rounds, put it off to a named time. The kit's line sits at 0.50 on purpose: you don't need an empty tank to come back, just one less than half full.

## My weather today: the room in your day

My weather today shows words, not numbers: a sky (clear, gusty or fogged in) and how much room you have today. Behind the words sits a rough tally from 0 to 100, where **higher means a heavier day**. You only see it if you tick "Show the numbers behind this."

| WHAT YOU PICKED | ADDS |
|---|---|
| The sky: clear, gusty, fogged in | 0, 26, 34 |
| The pressure: light, building, heavy (skipped: 6) | 0, 10, 20 |
| Last night's sleep: properly rested, about enough, short night, barely slept (skipped: 6) | 0, 2, 10, 18 |
| People load: barely any, a normal amount, a lot, nonstop (skipped: 4) | 0, 3, 9, 14 |

| WHAT YOU PICKED | ADDS |
|---|---|
| Ground conditions (hungry, thirsty, in pain and so on) | 4 each, up to 14 |
| What's blowing in (work, money, health and so on) | 3 each, up to 10 |

Under 45 reads as lots of room today, 45 to 64 as some room, and 65 or more as very little room.

WORKED EXAMPLE Joel, from Book 1, Chapter 2, page 25, picks gusty, building pressure, a short night, a lot of people time, one ground condition (hungry) and one thing blowing in (work).

`26 + 10 + 10 + 9 + 4 + 3 = 62`: some room today, with less than usual, so the forecast says to go gently and settle first.

## Workload balance: how evenly the hours are shared

**Two people.** Work out each person's share of the logged hours as a percentage.

```
balance = 1 − (the difference between the two percentages ÷ 100)
```

50/50 scores 1.00; one person doing everything scores 0.00. It doesn't matter which of you does more. Balance ignores the total, which is one reason the stress tank sits beside it.

WORKED EXAMPLE Rosemary logs 14 hours and Ken 10 (Book 4, Chapter 2, page 27). Out of 24 hours, that is 58.3% and 41.7%.

`1 − (58.3 − 41.7) ÷ 100 = 1 − 0.167 = 0.83`

**Three or more people, or an agreed split.** The same idea, said more generally: how much of the week would have to change hands to reach the target, compared with the most that ever could.

```
each share = that person's hours ÷ everyone's hours
target     = an even share (1 ÷ number of people), or the split you agreed
moved      = ½ × the sum of every |share − target|
most       = 1 − the smallest target share
balance    = 1 − moved ÷ most
```

WORKED EXAMPLE Three partners log 15, 9 and 6 hours (Book 4, Chapter 2, page 27): shares 0.50, 0.30 and 0.20, against a third each.

`moved = ½ × (0.167 + 0.033 + 0.133) = 0.167, most = 1 − 0.333 = 0.667, and balance = 1 − 0.167 ÷ 0.667 = 0.75`. In hours, 0.167 × 30 = 5 hours a week would change hands for an even split.

With an agreed split, use it as the target: co-parents who agreed 60/40 and log 12 and 8 hours score 1.00.

## Ownership: does every job have a name?

```
ownership = jobs with a named owner ÷ all the jobs on the list
```

The calculator counts a job as owned when it has one named owner. A backstop, the person who notices if it slipped, is a good habit and has its own column, but the score only needs the owner. The starter jobs on the worksheet don't count until you give them an owner or change them. Never raise the score by deleting the jobs nobody owns: they are exactly what the score is there to show.

WORKED EXAMPLE Rosemary and Ken list 12 regular jobs, and 9 have an owner: `9 ÷ 12 = 0.75`.

**Who carries more of the list.** A score of 1.00 can still mean one person owns everything, so One owner per job also shows each person's share of the list, with each job weighted by how often it comes round and how big it is:

```
weight of a job = how often × size
how often: daily 5, weekly 1, ongoing 1, monthly 0.25, as needed 0.1
size:      small 0.5, medium 1 (the default), big 2
           (or, where you gave the hours each time: hours ÷ 0.5)
share      = the weights of that person's jobs ÷ the weights of all the jobs
```

A job you decide together counts the same for each of you; on a list for two homes it shows as "Together" instead.

WORKED EXAMPLE One person owns the cooking (daily, medium: 5) and the bills (monthly, medium: 0.25). The other owns the laundry (weekly, big: 2) and the car (as needed, medium: 0.1). Each owns two jobs, but `5.25 ÷ 7.35 = 71%` of the list's weight sits with the first person, and 29% with the second.

**Who's carrying more right now.** Who did what flags the busiest person when their share of the logged minutes (or of the work done without being asked) is at least half, and at least 20 points over an even share: 70% or more for two people, 53% or more for three. In the example in Book 4, Chapter 1, page 7, one partner did 105 of the 115 minutes that were noticed and handled without anyone asking: 91%, so the sheet says so.

## The setup score: can the way you share the work last?

```
setup score = balance × 0.40
            + ownership × 0.35
            + (1 − the average tank score) × 0.25
```

The weights add up to 1, so the score runs from 0 to 1, and here **higher means the setup is working better**, the opposite of the tank score. The tank is the only part that counts against the score, which is why it enters as 1 − tank. 0.70 or more reads as working well (the "Who does what?" page says "holding"). From 0.40 up to 0.70 it reads as needs a look ("drifting"), and below 0.40 as needs a rethink, together. It is a snapshot of the setup, never a probability and never a verdict on anyone.

WORKED EXAMPLE Rosemary and Ken (Book 4, Chapter 2, page 27): balance 0.83, ownership 0.75, and their own tank scores are 0.45 and 0.30, an average of 0.375.

`0.83 × 0.40 + 0.75 × 0.35 + (1 − 0.375) × 0.25 = 0.333 + 0.263 + 0.156 = 0.75`: working well.

**The shortfall** is what each part could have earned minus what it did earn: balance 0.40 − 0.333 = 0.067, ownership 0.35 − 0.263 = 0.088, and tank 0.25 − 0.156 = 0.094. The biggest shortfall is the tank, which usually eases outside the chore list (more sleep, a lighter week elsewhere). The calculator's "what would help most" is the single change with the biggest gain: handing about 2 hours a week from Rosemary to Ken would take balance from 0.83 to 1.00, worth 0.067. Naming one more job's owner would be worth 0.029, and a tank score lower by 0.10 on average 0.025.

## The 30-day look-back: what shifted this month?

The look-back splits the last 30 days into four weeks (the first takes the first ten days). For each part you filled in (balance, ownership, the stress tank, and last-minute rescues), it compares the start of the month with the end:

```
start = the average of weeks 1 and 2
end   = the average of weeks 3 and 4
it shifted if end − start is 0.10 or more (balance, ownership, tank),
           or 1 a week or more (rescues); anything smaller didn't shift
```

**One next step:** a part that moved the wrong way comes first (the biggest move for its size). Otherwise, the first of these that is still true at the end: ownership under 0.70, balance under 0.70, 2 or more rescues a week, or anyone's tank at 0.60 or more. If none is, keep the same rhythm and look again in 30 days.

**Hours to change hands over the month:** for each person, the hours they did minus their share of everyone's hours, added up week by week. Half the sum of those gaps (ignoring the minus signs) is how many hours would change hands to make the month even.

WORKED EXAMPLE Suppose Rosemary and Ken keep going for a month (made up, like them). Their four weeks look like this. Hours: 14 and 10, 15 and 9, 13 and 11, 12 and 12. Jobs with an owner: 9, 9, 11 and 11 of 12. Rosemary's tank: 0.45, 0.50, 0.40 and 0.35, and Ken's 0.30 every week. Rescues: 3, 2, 1 and 1.

| PART | START (WEEKS 1–2) | END (WEEKS 3–4) | CHANGE | READS AS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Balance | (0.83 + 0.75) ÷ 2 = 0.79 | (0.92 + 1.00) ÷ 2 = 0.96 | +0.17 | Better |
| Ownership | 0.75 | 0.92 | +0.17 | Better |
| Average tank score | 0.39 | 0.34 | −0.05 | About the same |
| Rosemary's own tank | 0.48 | 0.38 | −0.10 | Lighter |
| Rescues a week | 2.5 | 1 | −1.5 | Fewer |

Three of the four parts shifted, all for the better, and nothing is left on the watch list, so the next step is to keep the rhythm. The setup score went from 0.73 to 0.87. Over the month Rosemary did 54 hours and Ken 42, so 6 hours would have changed hands for an even month.

## On your own: is your week sustainable?

The “Who does what?” page’s “just me” view adds up the hours your week is spoken for (jobs, the thinking work, care and so on) and compares them with a waking week of about 112 hours (16 waking hours, 7 days).

```
share = the hours spoken for ÷ 112
```

Under 50% reads as sustainable, 50% up to 70% as full but workable, and 70% or more as stretched. For example, 50 hours spoken for is 45%, which leaves real room; 80 hours is 71%, a lot to keep up week after week.

All of these are this book’s own ways of putting things into numbers. They have not been tested in research studies, and they shouldn’t be quoted as findings. The free calculators on the website do the arithmetic for you, and each one has a “How is this worked out?” note.

# Notes

# The series

*Spread Love & Acceptance is a series of short books. Each one stands on its own; read them in any order.*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Book 1 | **Know Yourself Kindly** | Start with yourself: your history, your wiring, your feelings, your worth and how your mind works. |
| Book 2 | **Heal and Steady** | For the heavy days: stress, anger, worry and low mood, grief, repair, change and what matters to you. |
| Book 3 | **Understanding Each Other** | Pace and tone, how words land, how we see each other, belonging, love, groups and helping well. |
| Book 4 | **Share the Load** | For homes, families and teams: seeing the unseen work, one owner per job, and two kinds of fair. |
| Workbook | **The Workpapers: The Bound Edition** *(this book)* | Every workpaper from the series in one bound book, with spare copies and the sums on paper. |
| Pocket guide | **The Logic Behind It** | Thirty-eight everyday reactions, one to a page, with the logic behind each one and a kind next step. |

*The print books are optional; everything stays free online at spreadloveandacceptance.com/book.*